
Northbank case study

A review of the unsecured-loan refinance funnel: where the funnel works, where customers drop off, and what to prioritise next.

See Interactive Case Study:
<https://northbank-casestudy.vercel.app/>

Date **15 Sept 2026**

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Three questions answered.

Q1

Refinance funnel review

Where it converts, where it leaks, and the verdict on both.

Q2

Customer survey summary

Four moments where trust breaks, on one page.

Q3

Next-quarter initiatives

Eight initiatives on impact vs effort, and why in that order.

Appendix

Caveats and method

What to trust, what to test, and every query behind it.

— QUESTION 1 OF 3

Using the data available, report on how the funnel is working — which areas are doing well, and which could be improved.

The funnel works after people engage. Most of the drop-off happens before they open the offer.

2.3% of offers become loans. The main bottlenecks are reach, value and completion.

OFFER → LOAN

2.3%

909 loans from 40,000 offers.

NEVER OPENED

62%

24,815 offers are never viewed. The largest leak.

PUSH EFFECT

~2×

higher offer view, apply and loan rates among push recipients.

£8.6M new loan balances written

£1.08M total-cost savings passed to customers

14.7% average APR on funded loans, avg. balance £9,509

Most losses happen at two points.

■ Carried forward ■ Lost at this step

40,000 offers, 909 loans. Each row shows what carried forward, what was lost and how each step converted.

STAGE	NOTE	SHARE OF ALL 40,000	LOST HERE	STEP CONV.
Offer sent	Every eligible customer. 45% received a push alongside email.		—	—
Viewed offer	62% of offers were never opened. The single largest leak.		−24,815	38.0%
Tapped apply	80.8% of everyone who viewed the offer never went on to apply.		−12,267	19.2%
Requirements done	39% stalled on standard identity and income checks.		−1,143	60.8%
Settlement uploaded	A median nine-day wait on the customer's old lender.		−439	75.3%
Settlement verified	Drop after settlement quote upload;		−358	73.2%
Loan funded	The strongest step in the funnel: 92.9% of verified applicants fund.		−69	92.9%

Everything from requirements onward converts at 60–93%. The largest losses occur in the first two customer decisions: opening the offer and choosing to apply.

Most of the loss happens before the application.

Offer reach is the largest observed leak. Offer value is the next key opportunity. Settlement verification is a confirmed hard stop for a smaller group.

DOING WELL

Push is associated with roughly 2× engagement
~2× lift in view, apply and loan rate at every stage, but only 45% of offers carry one.

Verified applicants almost always fund.
909 of 978 verified applicants are funded. The strongest step in the funnel.

Month-on-month performance is steady
Offer-to-loan holds flat at 2.1–2.6% across four matured cohorts.

COULD BE IMPROVED

01 Reach and engagement	Offer reach 62% never opened. 24,815 lost; largest observed leak.
	Repeat-offer policy Apply rate halves at every repeat offer ; 13.6% down to 2.0%.
02 Proposition & Intent	Offer value 12,267 viewers do not apply; total-cost saving is associated with higher view → apply.
	Application completion 39% never complete identity and income checks.
03 Conversion and servicing	Settlement verification 358 customers drop after quote upload; root cause requires investigation (e.g. is lender supported?)

— QUESTION 2 OF 3

Summarise the major findings from the customer survey for the product team in one slide or less.

Non-takers highlight four barriers.

Value, reassurance, effort and lender dependencies shape the decision.”

WEIGHING IT UP

15%

VALUE-SENSITIVE

A lower payment does not read as value when total repayment rises.

"Lower monthly but a longer term. I worked out I'd pay about £600 more in the end."

DECIDING TO COMMIT

~7%

REASSURANCE-SEEKING

Some customers want human reassurance before moving a meaningful balance.

"It's a big decision; I wanted a human not an app."

GETTING IT DONE

16%

TIME-CONSTRAINED

The self-serve journey is too hard to finish in one sitting.

"Started the application but it was taking too long so I left it."

HANDING OFF CONTROL

15%

LENDER-CONSTRAINED

An external dependency feels like abandonment without status or support.

"Waiting on my lender for the settlement figure, it never came."

The synthesis: These are four needs, not one "non-converter" group: clearer value, reassurance, less effort, and help with an external lender. Customers are weighing monthly payment and term length as much as total cost.

QUESTION 3 OF 3

Create a list of 5–10 initiatives to prioritise for the refinance cross-sell product next quarter, and briefly justify the ordering.

Eight recommendations, led by the biggest leak: four in five customers who see an offer never apply.

THEME	#	RECOMMENDATION	DESCRIPTION & EVIDENCE	PRIORITY
01 Reach & engagement	01	Expand offer reach	Expand push to more eligible customers and test send timing to increase offer visibility. 52.4% vs 26.0% viewed with vs without push.	Do now
	02	Test repeat-offer cadence and targeting	Test when and how often repeat offers are sent, and tailor the next offer to customer needs such as monthly payment vs total cost. View → Apply falls 31.1% → 6.7% from offer 1 to 4.	Do now
02 Proposition & intent	03	Improve offer value & framing	Review APR/term economics and test tailored value framing, such as monthly payment vs total saving. Only 19.2% of viewers apply; conversion varies materially by APR, term and total-cost saving.	Do now
	04	Set a total-cost saving threshold	Review offers that lower monthly payments but increase total cost; test whether clearer value framing or pricing changes improve uptake. 38.4% fall into this group.	Plan
03 Conversion & servicing	05	Simplify digital application experience	Reduce application effort by pre-filling known information and identifying the requirements causing abandonment. 60.8% complete requirements.	Plan
	06	Fix settlement verification drop-off	Capture why verification fails, then address the largest causes.	Plan
	07	Improve settlement status guidance	Give customers clearer progress, next steps and expectations while settlement is being verified. Survey feedback indicates uncertainty during the settlement wait.	Do now
	08	Test trust & reassurance interventions	Audit existing support/trust signals and test targeted in-app (or web) reassurance for hesitant customers (e.g. FAQs or contact options). Survey feedback indicates demand for human reassurance.	Fill-in

What to prioritise next quarter

Every initiative from the previous slide sits under its theme: what customers said, what the data shows, what we're assuming, and what we'd build

OPPORTUNITY	CUSTOMERS FEEL	WE'RE ASSUMING	NEXT QUARTER
01 Reach & engagement	"It was one email among many, and nothing followed it up."	Assumes the push lift is causal, not a proxy for app-engaged customers. Test: randomised push eligibility, send timing and cadence.	Channel orchestration — broader push eligibility, send-time testing and cadence control across push, email and in-app.
02 Proposition & intent	"Lower monthly but a longer term. I'd pay about £600 more in the end."	Assumes offer economics and framing drive the gap, not intent. Test: tailored value framing and minimum-saving thresholds.	Offer value engine — APR/term review, saving thresholds and value framing tuned to customer economics.
03 Conversion & servicing	"Started the application but it was taking too long so I left it." · "Waiting on my lender for the settlement figure, it never came."	Assumes drop-off is effort and uncertainty, not eligibility. The verification cause stays unknown until failure reasons are captured. Test: pre-filled flow, instrumented failures, proactive status.	Pre-fill and save-and-resume, failure-reason instrumentation, proactive settlement status and targeted reassurance.

Working notes, queries and tools.

APPROACH

01 • Start with the shape of the data Checked the CSV grain, date coverage and 1:1 application_id join before drawing conclusions.
02 • Where does the funnel actually break? Counted each dated event, then compared losses by volume and step conversion. The first two customer decisions dominate.
03 • Reach, value or completion? Split the funnel by push_sent, offer economics and repeat exposure; joined survey comments to explain the pattern, not prove it.
04 • What should happen first? Separated the confirmed verification constraint from hypotheses to test, then ranked work by customer impact, effort and dependency.

QUERY MAP

overall_funnel.sql headline volumes and offer-to-loan rate.
conversion_by_stage.sql step conversion and stage loss.
channel_effectiveness.sql push versus email-only comparison.
offer_quality_vs_conversion.sql offer economics and conversion.
repeat_exposure.sql repeat offer performance.
funnel_change_over_time.sql month-on-month stability.

TOOLS USED

ANALYSIS DuckDB-SQL	PRESENTATION Google Slides
AI TOOLS Claude Code	UX CodePen.io